Columbia University: International & Public Affairs
SIPA Course Evaluation - Summer 2021

Course: ENVPU6241_001_2021_2 - Earth Systems & Environmental Politics,
Instructor: Sara Tjossem
TA: Eugene Tan *
Response Rate: 11/66 (16.67 %)

20 - Please provide brief, specific, and constructive comments on the instructor's performance:

Sara Tjossem

Response Rate	11/66 (16.67%)

- Professor Sara has been a very supportive instructor. She was always ready to give valuable suggestions and has helped me improve my understanding of the subject.
- I think the course could benefit from being less theoretical and more practical and in the weeds of different policies
- No comments. Really enjoyed this course!
- Her teaching on concepts is abstract and doesn't have anything to take away from. She discusses concepts, but there is limited opportunity to use those concepts. A major impact on developing nations must be given coz thats a side of practical application of programs and policies students must be made aware of and not just USA! We are here to study world policy.
- Can rethink the way the course is taught as the initial appealing premise fell apart very quickly.
- Great professor but hard to teach because of the class size
- I wish Prof. Tjossem had drawn more on her personal experience to show us more practical policy applications.
- Tjossem really cares about the students and the subject.
- Professor Tjossem is a wonderful person with extreme passion for this field. She is extremely personable and friendly to approach and cares deeply about her students. Lectures were sometimes hard to follow though; tangents were informative but a bit distracting.
- Knowledge of a broad scope of environmental issues was really helpful because I started to think about them through a policy lens. It's really helpful to think about the different actors and roles policy places in intervention/prevention.
- NA

21 - The Teaching Assistants (TAs) contributed significantly to this course

Response Option	Weight	Frequency	Percent	Percent Responses	Means
Strongly disagree	(1)	1	9.09%		
Disagree	(2)	1	9.09%		3.64
Uncertain	(3)	1	9.09%		
Agree	(4)	6	54.55%		
Strongly Agree	(5)	2	18.18%		
N/A	(0)	0	0.00%		

0 25 50 100 — Question

Response Rate	Mean	STD	Median
11/66 (16.67%)	3.64	1.21	4.00

22 - Please provide brief, specific, and constructive comments on the TA's performance (if applicable)

Response Rate	6/66 (9.09%)

- so responsive and helpful with memo and op-ed comments
- Euegene was super helpful and his comments and feedback are well appreciated
- Average at best.
- Eugene was always helpful and available via email or zoom.
- Eugene provided good feedback on assignments.
- Eugene was great to work with and a fair grader.

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SIPA TA Evaluation - Summer 2021

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Response Rate: 4/66 (6.06 %)

1 - Technical knowledge of the course material

Response Option	Weight	Frequency	Percent	Percent Responses	Means
Poor	(1)	0	0.00%		4.00
Fair	(2)	0	0.00%		
Good	(3)	0	0.00%		
Very Good	(4)	3	75.00%		
Excellent	(5)	0	0.00%		
N/A	(0)	1	25.00%		
				0 25 50 100	Question

Response Rate	Mean	STD	Median
4/66 (6.06%)	4.00	0.00	4.00

2 - Performance during office hours

Response Option	Weight	Frequency	Percent	Percent Responses	Means
Poor	(1)	0	0.00%		4.00
Fair	(2)	0	0.00%		
Good	(3)	0	0.00%		
Very Good	(4)	3	75.00%		
Excellent	(5)	0	0.00%		
N/A	(0)	1	25.00%		
				0 25 50 100	Question

Response Rate	Mean	STD	Median
4/66 (6.06%)	4.00	0.00	4.00

3 - Performance during recitation/labs

Response Option	Weight	Frequency	Percent	Percent Responses	Means
Poor	(1)	0	0.00%		4.00
Fair	(2)	0	0.00%		
Good	(3)	0	0.00%		
Very Good	(4)	2	50.00%		
Excellent	(5)	0	0.00%		
N/A	(0)	2	50.00%		
				0 25 50 100	Question

Response Rate	Mean	STD	Median
4/66 (6.06%)	4.00	0.00	4.00

4 - Organization of the recitations/labs

Response Option	Weight	Frequency	Percent	Percent Responses	Means
Poor	(1)	0	0.00%		4.50
Fair	(2)	0	0.00%		
Good	(3)	0	0.00%		
Very Good	(4)	1	25.00%		
Excellent	(5)	1	25.00%		
N/A	(0)	2	50.00%		
				0 25 50 100	Question

Response Rate	Mean	STD	Median
4/66 (6.06%)	4.50	0.71	4.50

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5 - Ability to explain difficult concepts and make course material accessible

Response Option	Weight	Frequency	Percent	Percent Responses	Means
Poor	(1)	0	0.00%		
Fair	(2)	0	0.00%		3.33
Good	(3)	2	50.00%		
Very Good	(4)	1	25.00%		
Excellent	(5)	0	0.00%		
N/A	(0)	1	25.00%		
				0 25 50 100	Question

Response Rate	Mean	STD	Median
4/66 (6.06%)	3.33	0.58	3.00

6 - Availability to students

Response Option	Weight	Frequency	Percent	Percent Responses	Means
Poor	(1)	0	0.00%		
Fair	(2)	0	0.00%		3.67
Good	(3)	1	25.00%		
Very Good	(4)	2	50.00%		
Excellent	(5)	0	0.00%		
N/A	(0)	1	25.00%		
				0 25 50 100	Question

Response Rate	Mean	STD	Median
4/66 (6.06%)	3.67	0.58	4.00

7 - Ability to communicate student concerns to the course instructor

Response Option	Weight	Frequency	Percent	Percent Responses	Means
Poor	(1)	0	0.00%		
Fair	(2)	0	0.00%		3.67
Good	(3)	1	25.00%		
Very Good	(4)	2	50.00%		
Excellent	(5)	0	0.00%		
N/A	(0)	1	25.00%		
				0 25 50 100	Question

Response Rate	Mean	STD	Median
4/66 (6.06%)	3.67	0.58	4.00

8 - Attitude toward students

Response Option	Weight	Frequency	Percent	Percent Responses	Means
Poor	(1)	0	0.00%		4.33
Fair	(2)	0	0.00%		
Good	(3)	0	0.00%		
Very Good	(4)	2	50.00%		
Excellent	(5)	1	25.00%		
N/A	(0)	1	25.00%		
				0 25 50 100	Question

Response Rate	Mean	STD	Median
4/66 (6.06%)	4.33	0.58	4.00

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9 - Overall TA performance

Response Option	Weight	Frequency	Percent	Percent Responses	Means
Poor	(1)	0	0.00%		
Fair	(2)	1	25.00%		3.50
Good	(3)	0	0.00%		
Very Good	(4)	3	75.00%		
Excellent	(5)	0	0.00%		
				0 25 50 100	Question

Response Rate	Mean	STD	Median
4/66 (6.06%)	3.50	1.00	4.00

10 - Please provide brief, specific and constructive comments on the TA's performance

Response Rate	4/66 (6.06%)

- He was supportive and always ready to give any suggestions.
- Eugene was one of the better TAs this semester. He was available and helpful.
- Eugene provided helpful comments and feedback on papers.
- NA